

SUPPORT

SUPPORTS TERTIARY WHAT

FOR WHY-HOW · HOW-WHY

The Decision Deadline Ritual

A ritual that timeboxes analysis by setting the decision date in advance. **When the date arrives, you decide with the information in hand.**

THE DRAIN

For profiles whose energy lives in understanding, more analysis always feels justified, and deciding always feels premature. The cost is carried by everyone waiting: decisions age, options expire, and the team reads thoroughness as stalling.

WHAT THIS TOOL DOES

The ritual separates two questions that usually blur together: how good does the information need to be, and when does the decision happen. Both get answered at the start, in writing. Analysis then has a container, and the arrival of the date, not a feeling of readiness, triggers the decision.

The ritual

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|---|---------------------------|--|
| 1 | Name the decision | One sentence. What exactly is being decided? |
| 2 | Set the date | Proportional to the stakes, not to the interestingness of the analysis. |
| 3 | Define good enough | What information would genuinely change the answer? Only that gets gathered. |
| 4 | Decide on the date | With whatever is in hand. In writing, with reasons. |
| 5 | Log and move | Record the decision and the reasoning, then stop relitigating it. |

HOW TO USE IT

- 1 **Set the date with a witness.** A deadline only you know about is a suggestion. Tell the people waiting.
- 2 **Gather only what changes the answer.** Interesting is not the bar. Decisive is the bar.
- 3 **On the date, write the decision first.** Draft the answer, then check it against the evidence, not the other way around.
- 4 **Review the log quarterly.** You will find the delayed decisions rarely improved with time. That evidence recalibrates you.

WHAT IT WON'T DO

Some decisions genuinely deserve more time, and the ritual allows extending, once, out loud, with a new date. What it prevents is the silent rolling extension. It also will not make deciding on incomplete information comfortable; it makes it scheduled.

IN THE KIT

Decision sheet

Decision log

Extension protocol card

PAIRS WELL WITH

Tool 11 Good-Enough Threshold · **Tool 12** The Closing Card · **Tool 27** Assumption Audit